However, the number is much higher than in previous years. As a result, the government heavily increased its spending on the fire department. This increase was funded by raising local taxes.

But the truth is, the number of fires has *not* increased. The initial calculation was wrong because of someone's ignorance. If the person responsible knew anything about fire departments, they would know that each office building must perform obligatory fire drills every month and must test alarm systems bimonthly. All of that activity is logged as an alarm activation, but tagged with a different code than that used for a fire. If we could treat fire departments as a separate domain with their own Fire Incidents data product, this situation would probably not happen, because the people responsible for that domain would deeply understand its data.

To learn how to apply decentralization in a domain-oriented way, we will consider how business activities influence the design and ownership of data products. But how does this whole chapter fit into the bigger picture?

The goal of this chapter is to find possible boundaries of data products. This is a recurring, never-ending process. From the time you decide to go in a data mesh direction, you will have to constantly revisit boundaries of already existing data products and look for boundaries of those that you plan to create in the future.

In chapter 2, we showed you a simplified data mesh development cycle:

1. Choose the business case to enable with data.
2. Define data products needed (find the boundaries of data products required to solve that problem and choose owners).
3. Develop the data based on consumer needs and the discovered boundaries, and then treat the data as a product.
4. Improve or extend the platform based on the needs of the data product development team.
5. Establish or revisit governance policies that will enable further improvement of the mesh.
6. Measure whether you are going in the right direction and repeat the whole cycle.